Headings

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Headings are important for more than just making text stand out. Headings are especially important for the following:

- People who use screen readers
- People with cognitive difficulties
- Search engines

How to support it

Headings shouldn't be used for styling. They tell a screen reader that your text is a heading.

- There should only be one title (or `h1`) per document, slide, or web page
- Headings should follow in a sequential order. You can return to previous heading levels, but you should never skip a heading level on your way down (so `h4` to `h2` is perfectly fine, `h2` to `h4` is not)
- If you're using headings incorrectly, search engines will get the wrong information, and search engine optimisation (SEO) can suffer as a result

Useful Links

How to: Accessible heading structure

Arizona State University: Accessible headings

W3C WAI: Headings tutorial

Home Office Design System: Headings